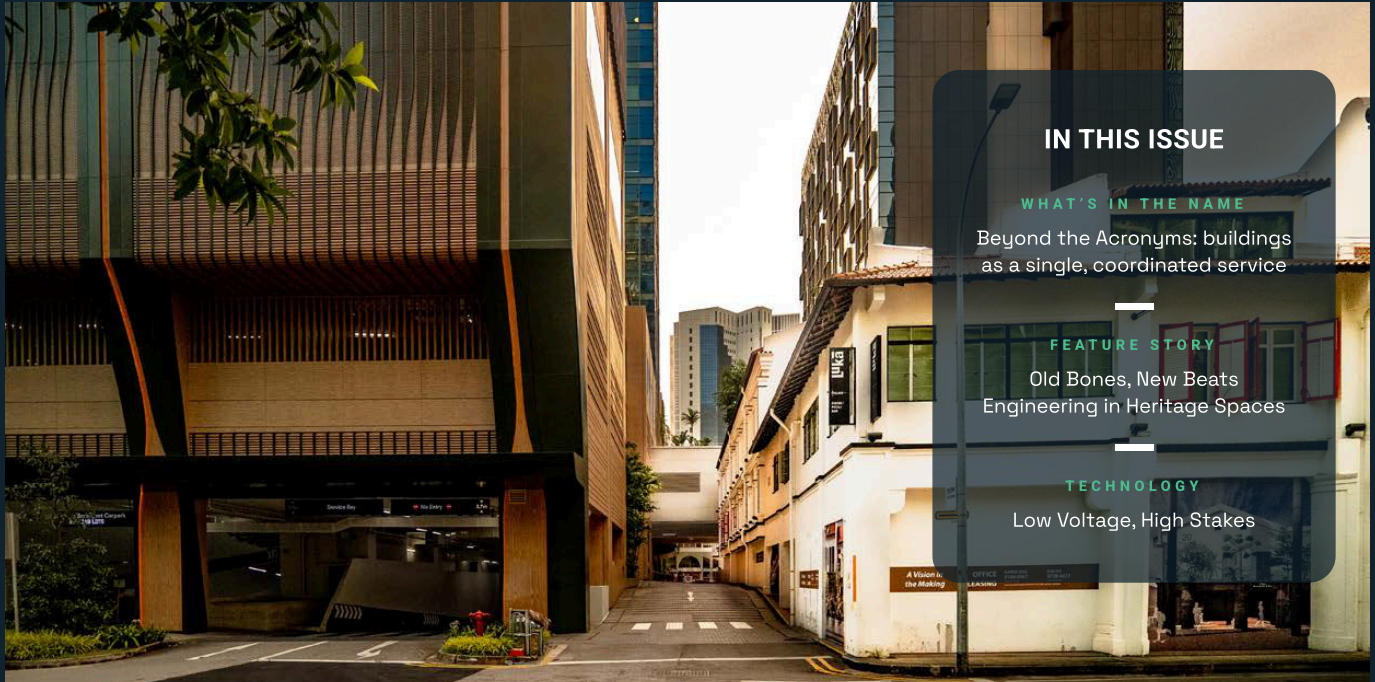


MINDWEP



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WHAT'S IN THE NAME

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FEATURE STORY

Old Bones, New Beats
Engineering in Heritage Spaces

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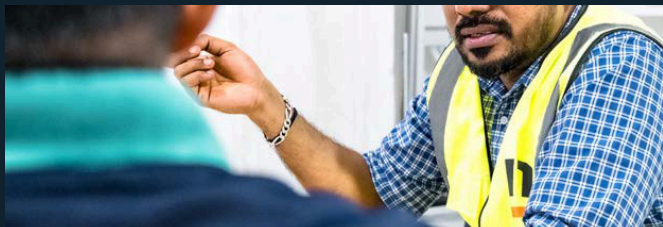
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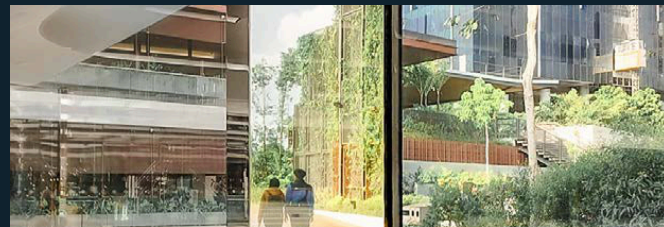
From Update Asia to General Manager for Singapore and Malaysia, Shan Nathan leads with hands-on MEP roots.

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Editor's letter

AZRYL ALI · EDITOR OF MINDMEP

Welcome to the very first issue of MINDMEP. We turned a simple capability statement into a magazine: we mapped the threads between projects, people and ideas like a mind map, then paired it with our core discipline, MEP.

MINDMEP connects how we think with what we build.

We also designed it to look fabulous on a coffee table. The A5 format sits neatly in reception or the living room, quiet yet bold, ready to be picked up and talked about.

On our cover, we spotlight one of the heritage buildings Mint is currently working on, a project that embodies the delicate balance between preserving history and enabling modern function.

In our feature article, Old Bones, New Beats, we take you inside Mint's growing capability in conservation engineering and the challenges of working within Singapore's heritage landscape.

This issue also introduces several key leaders in new roles: Shan Nathan, General Manager for Singapore and Malaysia; Nuno Rio Tinto, who now leads in Thailand; and Jaymee Recto, our Commercial Director.

For me personally, it has been a joy working alongside Mint Building Services and Mark Donlon over the past two years.



Thank you for reading this debut issue. I hope you find it as engaging to explore as it has been to put together.



Azryl Ali

Marketing Lead

azryl@mintbuildserv.com · +65 8922 6517

MINDMEP is published by Mint Building Services Pte Ltd in partnership with Alcove Communications for Mint's employees, subcontractors and clients.

mintbuildserv.com · alcovecomms.com



Managing Director's note

We launch this New Year issue of MINDMEP with a simple message: 2025 moved Mint forward.

Mark Donlon

Managing Director, Mint Building Services
mark@mintbuildserv.com

In Singapore, we stayed consistent where it matters most: repeat clients, clean programmes, quality you can see. In Malaysia, we turned momentum into presence, building out work in Kuala Lumpur and Penang. In Thailand, we entered, delivered, and handed over our first project, YETI's APAC workplace, on a 14-week programme. New market, same Mint standards.

These are not just new pins on a map. They reflect capability. Our BIM coordination is tighter, safety is firmer, and QA/QC is visible on site. We also began upgrading our BCA grading to L5 under Integrated Building Services, recognising who we are: an integrated delivery partner, not only an M&E installer.

We have added structure where it counts. The Commercial Director sets cost and contract discipline from bid to close-out. Two General Managers keep sites moving, resolve issues fast, and keep quality visible.

Clients get one clear point of contact, faster approvals, and predictable handovers.

You will see that thread through this issue: from Old Bones, New Beats on conservation engineering, to the Thailand spotlight and profiles of the people leading our next phase.

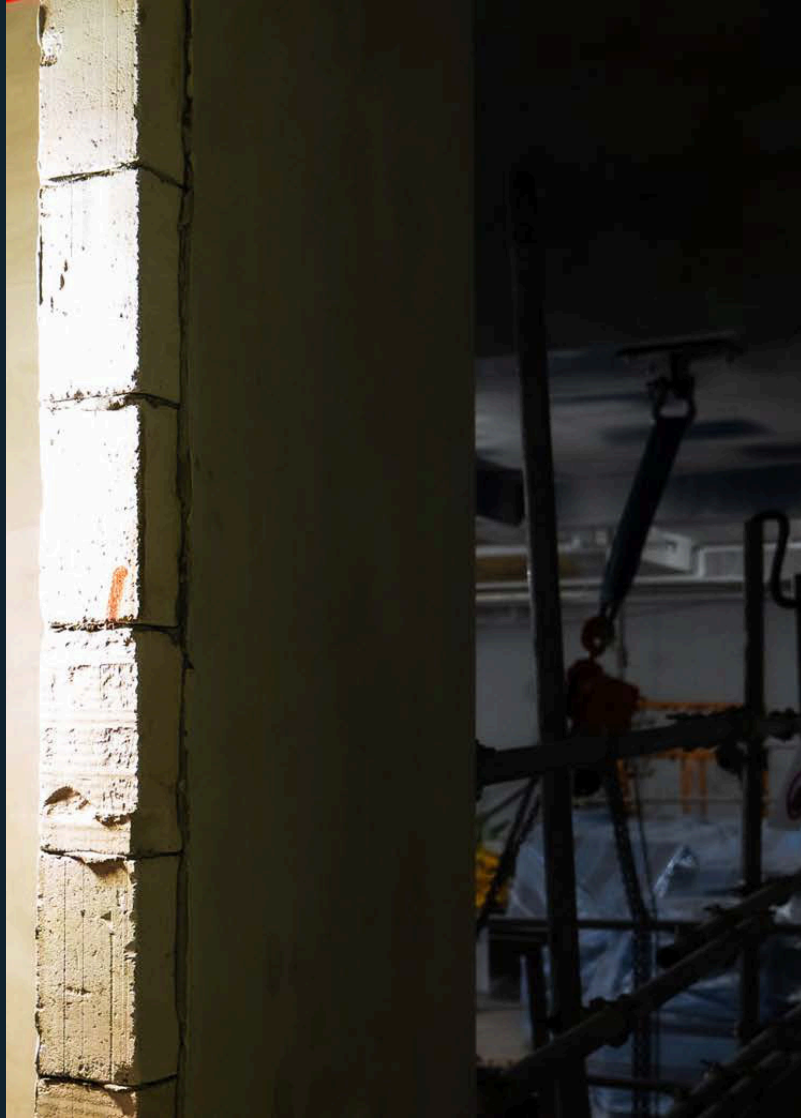
We do not just install systems. We engineer outcomes.

The promise is unchanged, with agility, technical exactness, and a calm focus on quality.

Thank you to our clients, partners, and the Mint team for a strong year. Here's to a safe and prosperous 2026.

BEYOND THE ACRONYMS

Buildings are no longer a collection of systems. They are a single, coordinated service.



Beyond the acronyms

M

int Building Services carries a relatively new name in the region. The business behind it has been delivering projects since 2010. A management buyout in 2022 laid the foundation for its next stage, driven by the commitment and determination of the leadership team. Since then, the company has expanded its sector coverage and regional

presence, broadened its technical capability, and established a clear framework for disciplined growth across Southeast Asia.

We are an M&E contractor

Walk onto any live construction site in Southeast Asia and ask for the M&E contractor, and you will be pointed in the right direction. The term is familiar and widely understood.

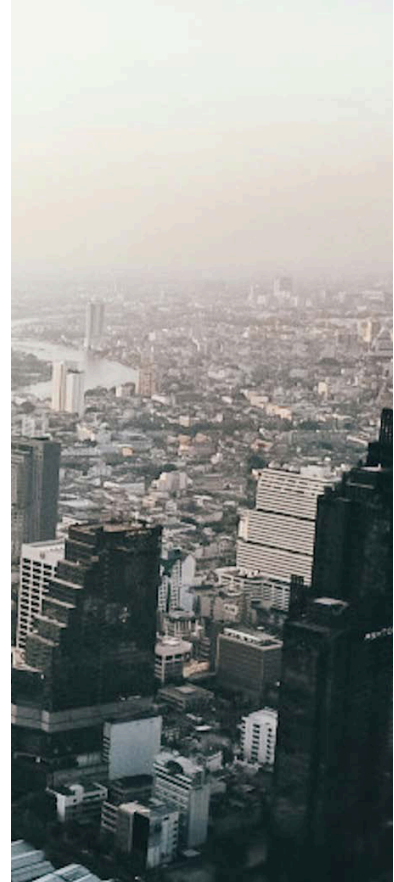
But mechanical and electrical systems no longer operate in isolation. Building performance now depends on how these systems are integrated to deliver reliable, efficient operation over time.

Building Services is a more accurate reflection of this role. Rather than describing individual trades, it refers to the full network of systems required for a building to function.

Successful project outcomes are no longer measured by the quality of installation alone, but by how well systems are coordinated and how they perform once handed over.

Client expectations have shifted with it. Projects increasingly require a single partner who understands both construction delivery and how a building will operate in practice. The term Building Services reflects that broader scope and level of responsibility.

Bangkok, Mint's third market and the newest node in a Southeast Asia network built on repeatable delivery.



We deliver building services

Together, this is what we define as Building Services: an approach we have delivered for more than 15 years across the commercial, hospitality and retail sectors.

Core systems, delivered direct

MV and LV distribution, ductwork and pipework are delivered in a traditional manner, using our own workforce and direct procurement of materials. This gives us control over quality, programme and cost across the core installation works.

Integrated delivery

As a project moves into full system installation, the scope shifts from individual trades to integrated delivery. Systems such as lighting controls, BMS integration, and fire alarm and sprinkler modifications must be managed and coordinated as a single package.

Technology in house

ICT systems sit alongside this. Our in-house technology division manages and coordinates client vendors for IT, AV and security, ensuring alignment with the wider building systems.

Building regional capability

As demand grew for contractors capable of delivering comprehensive building services packages, a clear opportunity emerged to expand beyond Singapore into Malaysia and Thailand. This enabled Mint to support clients on a regional basis.

The company's early focus centred on commercial office environments and workplace fit-outs, where coordination, programme management and cost control are fundamental to successful delivery.

Over time, projects expanded in both scale and complexity: from multi-phase hospitality developments in Singapore to flagship retail environments in Malaysia and industrial facilities in Thailand.

Today, with continued growth in mission-critical facilities across the region, Mint's capability to deliver across the full building services spectrum provides a strong platform for what comes next.

The name says it plainly. The work confirms it.



Mint in Thailand

Mint has entered Thailand with clear intent: bring our trusted MEPF delivery model to Bangkok and build lasting client relationships through speed, quality and accountability. The launch is anchored by our first completed project in the Kingdom, YETI's APAC workplace, delivered on a 14-week programme with full MEPF scope.

Our Thailand team pairs local subcontractors and suppliers with Mint's design-assist and buildability mindset, so decisions are made early and procurement matches how the job will actually be built.

Got a project opportunity in **Thailand**? Get in touch:



Nuno Rio Tinto

General Manager, Thailand
nuno@mintbuildserv.com
+66 (0) 83 170 5304

ON SITE NOW

Live work from across the business, in phases, in occupied buildings, on programme.

REPI Tuas Warehouse
Singapore · 12,300 sq ft

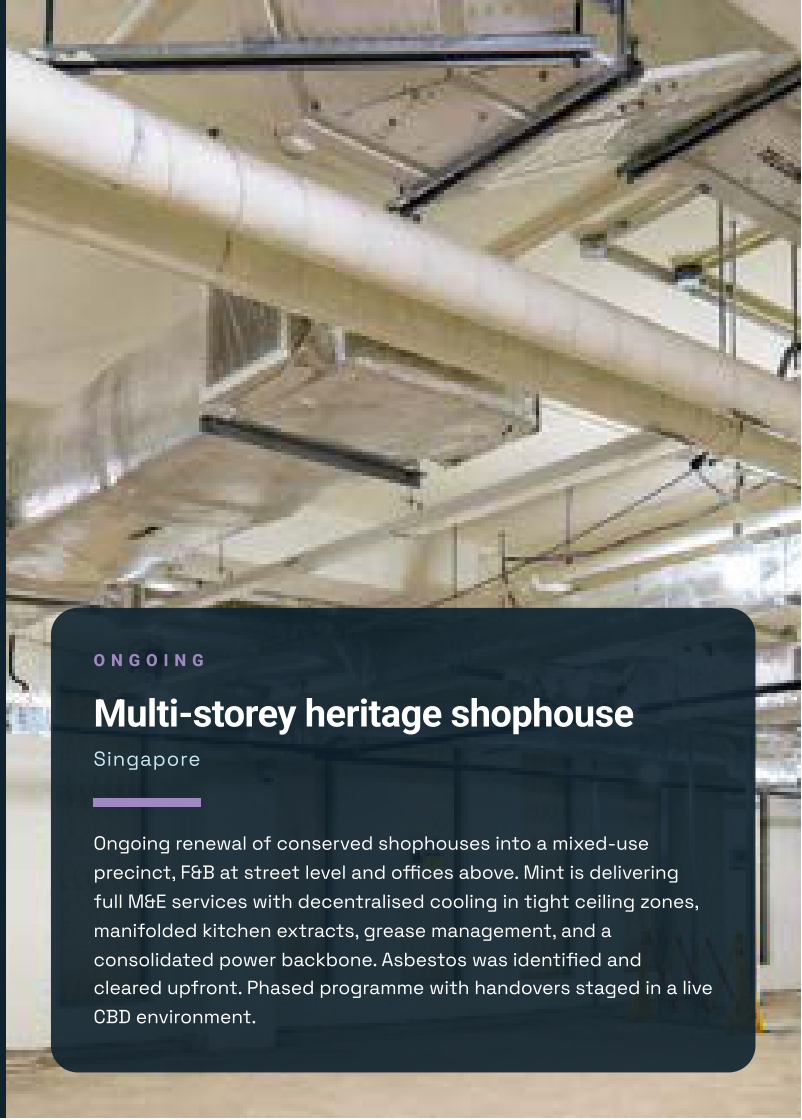
Oracle Experience Centre
Singapore

ONGOING

Multi-storey heritage shophouse

Singapore

Ongoing renewal of conserved shophouses into a mixed-use precinct, F&B at street level and offices above. Mint is delivering full M&E services with decentralised cooling in tight ceiling zones, manifolded kitchen extracts, grease management, and a consolidated power backbone. Asbestos was identified and cleared upfront. Phased programme with handovers staged in a live CBD environment.





The Laurus at Resorts World Sentosa

Singapore · 350 keys

Supporting the transformation of the former Hard Rock Hotel into a new luxury destination, Mint delivered the full mechanical services installation across guest rooms and suites, including ACMV and associated systems. The project was delivered in multiple phases and successfully handed over in October 2025.



Eastern Pacific Shipping

Singapore · 9,700 sq ft

For a global maritime firm's new headquarters, Mint delivered the full MEPF design and build, including auxiliary cooling for gym areas and acoustic insulation for meeting spaces. Completed in just nine weeks, the project transformed a blank floorplate into a fully operational workspace.



Coriander Leaf

Singapore · 4,500 sq ft ·
Completed 2025

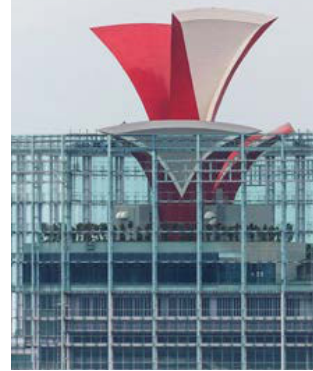
Mint delivered the full M&E design and build for the restaurant's new flagship at 20 Craig Road, covering kitchen, lighting, power and climate control systems. Completed in March 2025 under a 14-week programme.

APJ data centre company

Singapore · 27,800 sq ft · Completed

We delivered the full MEPF design and build for a corporate office within the LEED Platinum certified Ocean Financial Tower.

Completed in 14 weeks, the installation met the tower's sustainability and performance standards, integrating precision engineering with efficient, low-impact systems.



One Farrer Hotel

Singapore · Completed 2025

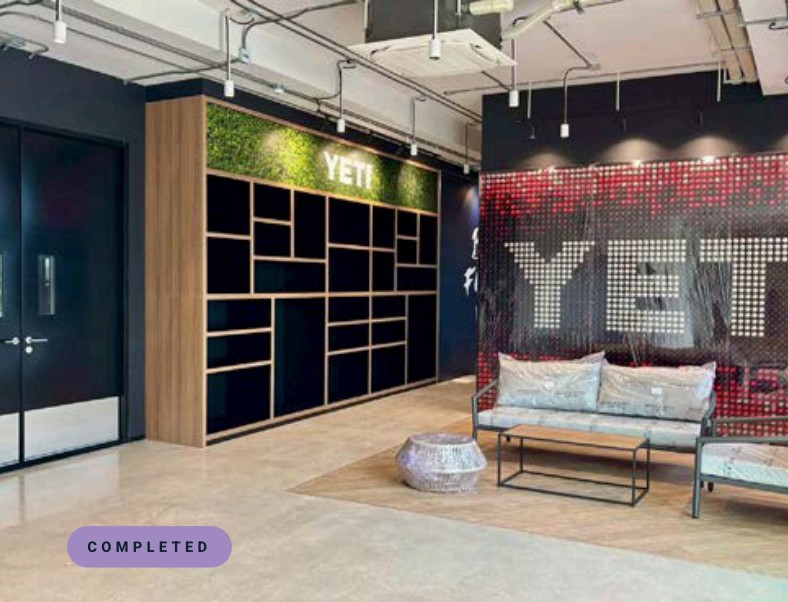
Mint delivered the full MEPF package for the hotel's refurbishment, completed in January 2025 under a 16-week programme, with works sequenced inside a live hotel.



CapitaGreen

Singapore · Completed

Mint returned two office floors to base build condition, carrying out a full M&E infrastructure upgrade covering mechanical, electrical and associated services.



COMPLETED

YETI APAC Workplace

Thailand · 14-week programme

Mint delivered the full MEPF scope: ACMV ceiling cassette systems, electrical distribution and plug-and-play power, plumbing and fire protection, plus low-voltage and structured cabling with testing and commissioning. Completed on a 14-week programme from kick-off to handover, and the first Mint project handed over in the Kingdom.



COMPLETED

Codemasters Studio

Malaysia · 20,000 sq ft

Mint delivered the full MEP package for EA Sports' new corporate office across two phases at The Exchange 106, TRX. The first phase completed in April 2024, the second in July 2025. Working inside a high-spec corporate environment, Mint provided mechanical, electrical and plumbing solutions built for functionality, efficiency and precision.

FROM PROJECT FLOOR

Shan Nathan

General Manager, Singapore and Malaysia



TO STRATEGY ROOM



You don't always see it coming: the moment you realise you've helped build something bigger than yourself.

For Shan Nathan, that moment didn't arrive with a fancy title or a corner office. It crept in quietly between site walks, sleepless nights, and one particularly wild post-rebrand project that tested everything Mint had just declared itself to be.

S

han has been there from day one. Back when Mint was still Update Asia. Back when the team was small, the hustle was real, and nothing moved without a hundred hands, and probably a few late-night coffees.

But what made him stay through the transition wasn't nostalgia. It was trust. In Mark. In the vision. And in the chance to build, not just buildings, but a business.

"I didn't plan to become a General Manager," he says. "I just focused on delivering projects." But growth has a funny way of finding those who keep showing up.

One day you're knee-deep in coordination drawings; the next, you're steering operations across two countries.

Shan's background in electrical engineering and MEP coordination wasn't something he left behind when he moved into management. It is what shapes his leadership today: practical, grounded, and unshaken by pressure.



He hires for attitude. He trains for potential. He leads with presence.

Because strategy means nothing if your team can't feel you in the trenches when it matters.

Two markets, one thread

Across Singapore and Malaysia, Shan leads with a consistent thread: resilience. “Hire for attitude and potential,” he says. “Then invest. Train. Align on goals. And stay present.”

He knows each market comes with its own rhythm. Regulations differ. Work cultures clash. But adaptability isn’t a skill you teach; it is something you practise. And Shan has been practising it for years.

The subcontractor model that Mint operates on isn’t always an easy one, but for Shan the key is clear communication, constant coordination, and never assuming something is under control until you have verified it yourself.

“The ones who impress me most aren’t just technically strong. They’re proactive. They solve problems before I even know they’re problems.”

Looking back, he is proud of what Mint has become. But he doesn’t romanticise it. He knows what it took to get here.

And if there is one thing he hopes the next generation of engineers understands, it is this: “Be curious. Stay hands-on. Take ownership. And be ready to fall down a few times. That’s where the real learning happens.”

Because in this industry, the path to leadership doesn’t always look like a ladder.

Coordination drawing, Singapore.

Sometimes it looks like scaffolding: messy, temporary, but strong enough to carry you if you are willing to climb.

MIND OVER MONEY

Two cities shaped her mindset. The Philippines taught resilience and not to dwell on tough days. Singapore taught discipline and respect for diversity. Together they inform how she reads people, programmes, and risk.

Jaymee Recto

Commercial Director



J

aymee Recto did not fall for economics in a lecture theatre. “To be honest, I don’t like economics,” she says with a laugh. Trained as a civil engineer at Mapúa, she came up in a system without a formal QS track. “You can’t price what you don’t know how to design and build.”

Site, numbers, schedule. That mix clicked.

After graduating she tried estimating, which felt too removed from site, then QA/QC, which was heavy on administration. A chance to work in Singapore introduced her to quantity surveying.

She was, by her own admission, “clueless about what a QS was then,” but the role put her where she wanted to be: on site. Watching the work, valuing variations from real conditions, and tracking time against money made sense to her.



Money is on site

Speed sharpened her instincts at ISG and TCG. Huawei rollouts were the testing ground. “You win those jobs during procurement by involving the site team early. Things move faster when procurement is informed by how the work will really be done.”

The QA/QC lens never left either. “Quality delivered on time is what leaves a mark. Get those two right and clients come back.” She also rejects the myth that QS work is desk bound.

Moving to Mint Building Services completed the loop. She had learned shell and core, then fit-out. What she wanted was the part that makes a building work.

Building services turns a structure into a system of power, plant, and control. It is also a different commercial seat. As a specialist, Mint must be nimble and exact, aligning design with means and methods while protecting margin.

Success now feels shared. Big contractors often measure by individual KPI. At Mint, small wins are noticed and celebrated. Repeatable delivery, tidy close-outs, and healthy cash are the markers.

For Jaymee, cost management is how agility and quality become real. Deliver on time, with quality, within budget. Give clients best value, not just the lowest line on a spreadsheet.

She backs two habits that reduce risk: structured cost and time reviews at start, mid-point and pre-close, and rigorous use of BIM and reliable supply chains to surface clashes early and lock lead times.

Some commercial edges stay in the playbook, but early alignment on scope, temporary systems and testing keeps disputes down.

Outside work she resets with music, art and books. Late-night cost plans run on coffee, black and hot. Favourite buildings: the Orchard Road malls for commercial complexity, and the Fullerton Hotel for beauty.

Advice to her 22-year-old self: enjoy every moment and every opportunity. Asked about the move to Mint, she is already sure it was worth it.

Looking ahead she sees a busy decade. “Construction in 2035 will be massive,” she says. Revamps and regulatory updates will drive the work.

The future belongs to those who think clearly, act early, and keep the numbers honest on site.

LINE BY LINE, PIPE BY PIPE

—

From first win to steady flow, Nuno sets out a Thailand playbook built on early alignment, realistic programmes, and outcomes clients can trust.



N

uno Rio Tinto did not come to Mint to keep the lights on. He came to switch on a market. Bangkok was not a lightning bolt. “There wasn’t a single moment, more like a slow hum that got louder,” he says. He wanted warmth, a little chaos, creative energy.

Central Embassy in Phloen Chit became his unofficial base: breakfasts, lunches, coffees, conversations that started casual and ended with next steps.

Nuno arrived with more than a decade across business development, strategy and operations, including leading Swift Property Maintenance in the UK.

That mix now focuses on Thailand. Spot the right opportunities. Shape clear scopes. Keep programmes realistic. Build teams that actually do what they say.

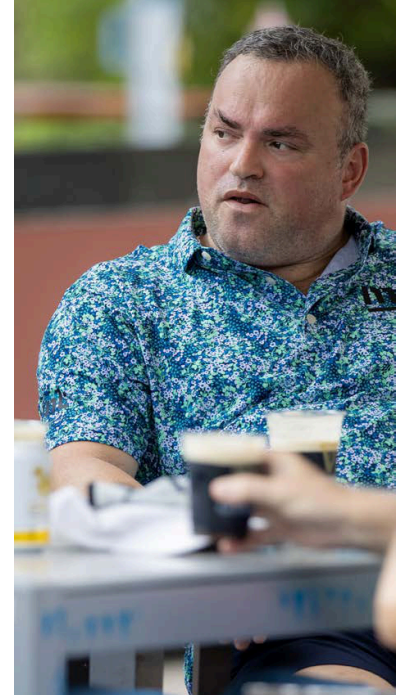
The first proof point came quickly with the YETI APAC workplace. Tight brief, tighter timeline. Fourteen weeks from start to handover.

Early alignment on site, clear lead times from suppliers, and M&E decisions shaped by how things are really built, not just how they look on a drawing.

The result was a clean handover and a project that says to future clients, “This is what you can expect.”

Bangkok, where most of the pipeline still begins over a table rather than in a tender portal.

The challenges feel exciting, not exhausting.



What good looks like in a year

Ask him what a right project feels like and he talks about energy, not scale. You can see where your effort matters. That feeling is now a filter. Bid where the programme can stay honest, where long-lead items can be locked in early, where people prefer fewer surprises and clearer choices.

Outside of work, small rituals keep the pace grounded. Port FC matches. Solo coffees to think about what he can improve. Early gym sessions so the day does not set the terms.



Nuno Rio Tinto, General Manager, Thailand.

From the UK he keeps two rules close: listen first, and if you say you will do something, do it. Bangkok added one more lesson: be patient. “I was used to things happening much faster in the UK. I had to learn quickly to be patient.”

Look a year ahead and he defines good in simple terms. Two or three projects that made a visible difference, work recognised for clarity, creativity and solid outcomes. A team that has grown in capability and confidence.

Newer members stepping up. Shared habits that make collaboration smoother instead of draining.

For Mint, Thailand is not a one-off. It is the next chapter in a Southeast Asia story written the same way wherever we work: agile coordination, reliable programmes and quality you can see at handover.

Ask Nuno what he wants a client to say at the end of a job and he does not hesitate. That Mint is trustworthy. That Mint knows what it is doing. That they would be happy to work with Mint again.

That is how a first project becomes a pipeline. One right decision, one right relationship, one right project at a time.

OLD BONES

NEW BEATS

Engineering comfort into buildings that remember everything

Conserved shophouses, Cross Street, Singapore

Engineering comfort into buildings that remember everything.

Singapore's skyline shimmers with glass and steel. But between the towers stand quiet survivors: buildings that hold the city's memory in their masonry, their timber joists, their narrow five-foot ways. Most people walk past without a second thought. For an engineer, they demand a very different kind of thinking.

Bringing these properties back to life requires creativity, care and respect. It is preservation and progress at once: modern systems carefully woven into century-old frameworks without erasing their stories.

7,000+

buildings conserved in Singapore since 1989



Conserved shophouse frontage, Singapore. Gazetting protects streetscapes, not just individual buildings.

Protecting the city's architectural DNA

Singapore's approach to building conservation is grounded in legislation. The Preservation of Monuments Act, enacted in December 1970, established the legal framework to protect buildings and sites of national significance, leading to the formation of the Preservation of Monuments Board. This early legislation ensured that landmarks of historical, architectural and cultural importance could be

formally gazetted and safeguarded.

The broader urban conservation regime emerged in 1989, when the Urban Redevelopment Authority formalised its conservation programme and introduced statutory planning controls for entire precincts. Historic areas such as Chinatown and Little India were among the first to be gazetted, marking Singapore's shift toward area-based conservation.

Preservation and the modern city

As cities grow denser and more vertical, the pressure to rebuild and replace is constant. Yet the preservation of historic buildings plays a role in maintaining cultural depth, human scale and a sense of identity. Conservation allows the past and present to coexist, creating places that feel rooted and distinctive rather than anonymous and interchangeable.

In Singapore, this role carries particular weight. A multicultural, multi-ethnic society shaped by waves of migration, the city's built heritage reflects the lived histories of its communities. Preserving districts such as Chinatown, Little India and Kampong Glam maintains a shared identity that binds communities together, ensuring that rapid urban change does not erase the physical and cultural traces of the past.



Strip-out at 21 Keppel Road: a century-old frame, opened up and surveyed before a single new service was routed.

21 Keppel Road and 18 Cross Street

Mint Building Services delivered the complete mechanical and electrical scope across both 21 Keppel Road and 18 Cross Street, two projects located within URA-designated conservation contexts. In each case, delivery was shaped by strict constraints on retained façades, roof forms and structural fabric, requiring services strategies to be developed around the existing buildings rather than imposed upon them.

21 Keppel Road was originally constructed in the early twentieth century as the Customs Operations Command, an administrative and operational hub linked to Singapore's port and maritime trade. Designed in a restrained colonial style, the building reflects a period when civic architecture was both functional and symbolic.

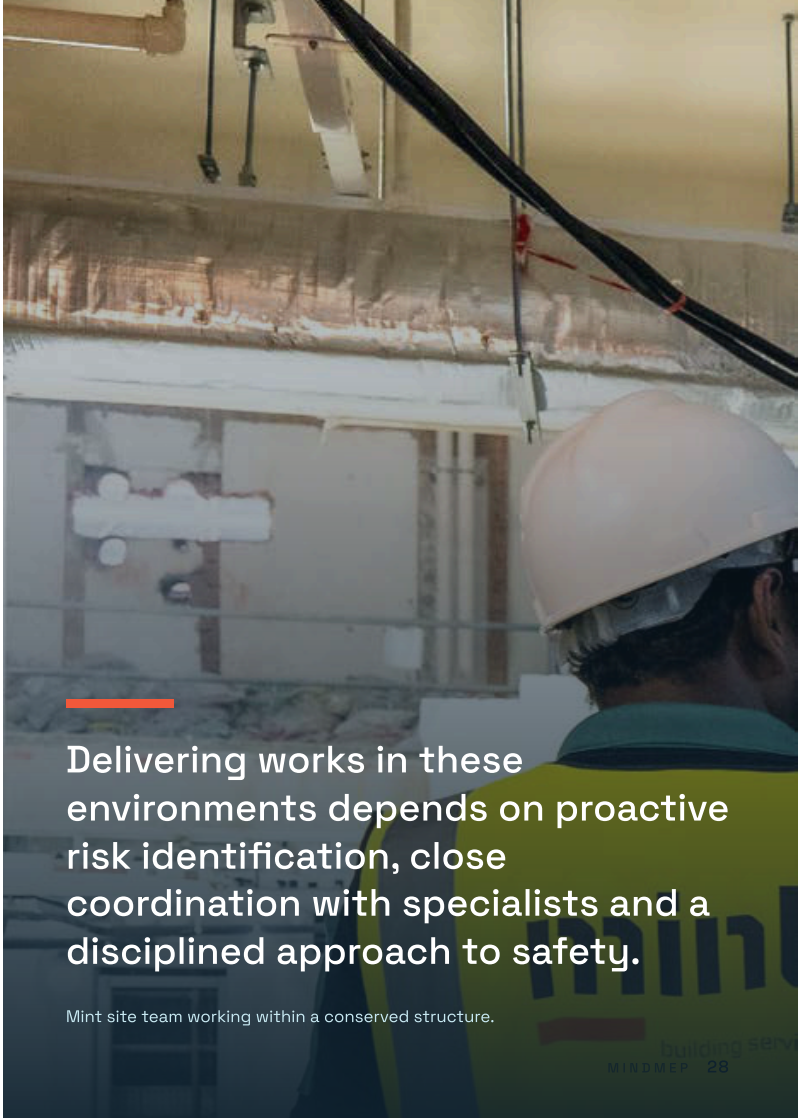
The conserved shophouses at 18 Cross Street date back to the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, forming part of Singapore's historic commercial core. Typical of shophouse developments from this period, they were built to support trade, commerce and community life, with narrow frontages, sheltered five-foot ways and robust masonry construction.

Delivering safely in conserved structures

Working within historic buildings brings challenges that extend beyond design and delivery. Structures built decades ago, and in some cases more than a century ago, were never intended to accommodate modern loading, services density or contemporary construction methodologies. Hidden structural weaknesses, material degradation and undocumented alterations are common, making early surveys,

intrusive investigations and careful sequencing essential.

There is also an elevated risk of hazardous materials, particularly asbestos, which was widely used in building construction well into the late twentieth century. In conservation projects, asbestos may be concealed within ceiling voids, service risers, floor finishes or fireproofing systems, requiring specialist surveys, controlled removal and strict compliance with safety regulations.

A photograph showing a construction worker from behind, wearing a white hard hat and a high-visibility yellow vest. The worker is positioned in front of a complex ceiling structure with exposed pipes, ducts, and electrical conduits. The scene is dimly lit, with light coming from above, highlighting the textures of the ceiling materials.

Delivering works in these environments depends on proactive risk identification, close coordination with specialists and a disciplined approach to safety.

Mint site team working within a conserved structure.

Navigating complexity

Delivering modern building services within historic structures sits at the intersection of engineering, regulation and stewardship. As conservation continues to shape Singapore's urban fabric, these projects demand teams with experience navigating technical complexity, regulatory nuance and the realities of working within aged structures.

The old bones hold stories. The new beats, the ACMV systems, the power backbones, the fire protection networks threaded carefully through heritage walls, keep those stories liveable.

That is the work.



More than 7,000 buildings have been conserved since Singapore's area-based conservation programme began. The streetscape survives because the services inside it were rethought.

21 KEPPEL

**STRIPPED BACK,
POWERED FORWARD**

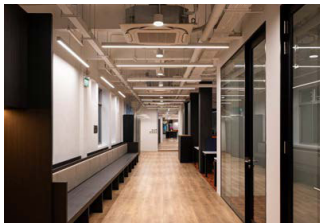
Upgrading a heritage asset for modern
occupancy.

21 Keppel Road, Singapore — from Customs House to innovation hub.

BeyondX (21)
From Customs House
to Innovation Hub

The building at 21 Keppel Road had stood for over a century before anyone asked it to house an innovation hub. Originally constructed as the Customs Operations Command, an administrative and operational hub linked to Singapore's port and maritime trade, it carried the weight of colonial-era civic architecture. Restrained, functional, symbolic. Not designed for EV charging stations or open-plan workspaces or façade lighting synced to the energy of the teams inside.

In 2023, that became its brief.



A full refurbishment: contemporary workplace, heritage envelope. Project Innovation led the delivery; Mint took the complete MEP and fire protection scope under design and build.



The project was initiated as a full refurbishment with the aim of transforming the asset into a contemporary workplace aligned with BeyondX's innovation-led ethos.

Early contractor involvement

Mint was appointed at concept stage, shortly after the architectural layout plans were presented to stakeholders and approved in principle. Under an early contractor involvement arrangement, Mint provided technical input to support design development before it was fixed.

Initial works focused on comprehensive pre-condition

surveys of the main incoming services, power, water and drainage, to confirm available capacity, assess suitability for reuse and identify compliance requirements. In parallel, detailed internal surveys mapped the existing structure and spatial constraints, informing equipment placement, floor-to-ceiling allowances and routing ahead of detailed design.

Design and build

The project was delivered under a design and build model, giving Mint single-point responsibility for both design development and construction delivery. The in-house team carried out surveys, equipment selection, system sizing and the preparation of coordinated drawings in CAD and Revit. The design was reviewed and endorsed by Qualified Professionals, Professional Engineers and Licensed Plumbers to ensure statutory compliance.



Services coordinated within the retained structure: containment, ductwork and distribution routed before ceilings closed.

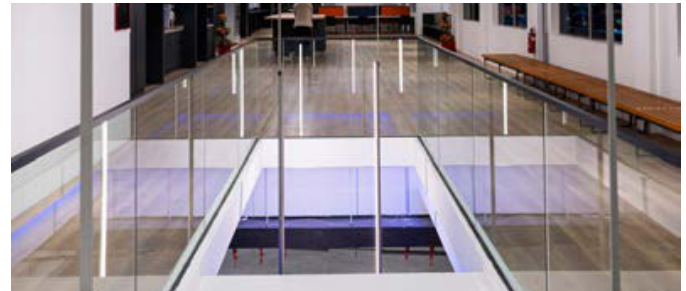
Hidden surprises

A standout feature of the development was the integration of EV charging technology. Early investigations identified that the existing incoming electrical capacity was insufficient to support the proposed load. Mint designed and coordinated the required power upgrade.

Further surveys revealed that the existing external water and sanitary pipework did not meet current standards, requiring full replacement. The sprinkler and fire alarm systems needed upgrading, along with the wider LV electrical distribution, air-conditioning and ventilation

systems. The building was brought in line with current codes and performance expectations.

Through early contractor involvement, Mint overlapped traditional project phases to compress the delivery programme. Once the basis of design, budget and programme were agreed, site preparation commenced in parallel with detailed design development. The condition of the building necessitated a full strip-out, carried out efficiently due to early access and advance planning.



Delivery and installation

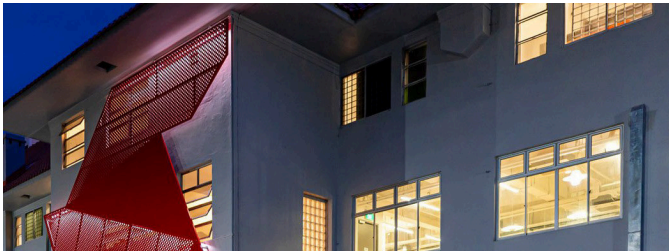
As works progressed, the true condition of the upper floor became apparent. The existing ceiling and roof structure were no longer fit for purpose, requiring replacement of the original joists and supports with a new steel framework. This structural intervention created a dramatic internal volume, but also introduced new technical challenges.

The increased ceiling height required careful development of the ACMV strategy to ensure effective air distribution and occupant comfort. Mint worked

closely with the structural engineers to integrate pipework and cable containment within the new steel structure.

Externally, lighting defined the character of the building. In close coordination with the lighting specialist and local authorities, a façade lighting scheme was developed to reflect the fast-paced, technology-driven nature of the teams working within.

Installation required detailed planning and coordination with road authorities, including temporary road closures.



Façade lighting, installed under night closures with the road authorities.

The return engagement

The delivery of the 21 Keppel refurbishment reflects the value of early contractor involvement, disciplined design development and close coordination across the project team. By identifying constraints early, managing risk proactively and maintaining alignment on cost, programme and scope, the project was delivered efficiently while meeting BeyondX's objectives.

The working relationships strengthened through the project led to continued engagement and repeat opportunities on subsequent work. A century-old building, wired for its next chapter. That is what happens when old bones meet new engineering.

NEXT – PROJECT SHERLOCK

If BeyondX transformed one building, Project Sherlock scales it up: an ongoing redevelopment of conserved shophouses in China Square into a mixed-use enclave of offices by day and restaurants by night. Mint's role is delivering full M&E services that bring 19th-century architecture up to 21st-century standards.



ONGOING — CHINA SQUARE

Project Sherlock

Each shophouse carries a distinct story. Timber floors, ornate façades, and narrow airwells leave very little room for modern services. Mint's job is to thread infrastructure through these layers without disturbing their character.

The first hurdle was asbestos, identified early and removed by specialists before other works began. The decision added time upfront but created a safe and predictable site for everyone that followed.

Low ceilings led to a decentralised ACMV scheme with slim fan coils above door heads and discreet bulkheads. Ground-floor F&B extracts were manifolded at the rear to keep façades clean and roof terminations to a minimum.

Upgrades that stay invisible

Plumbing added grease management and compact booster sets in under-stair niches. A consolidated substation now feeds metered wayleaves to each unit.

Where chasing would harm brickwork, surface containment is concealed behind joinery or within new partitions.

Precision, sequencing and sensitivity

Working alongside main contractor partners, Mint planned trade sequencing with care. When a new escalator opening was cut between two shophouses, the team used that window to install vertical ducting and cabling before slabs were closed.

In a live CBD environment, quieter compact piling rigs reduced vibration and protected

fragile foundations. Project Sherlock is still unfolding, yet the lessons are clear: progress in conservation comes from precision and restraint.

As each shophouse reopens, façades read as they always have while modern systems remain hidden. Visitors will feel the history rather than the engineering, which is exactly the outcome Mint aims for.

Together, BeyondX and Project Sherlock show that conservation engineering is craft and care in equal measure. Progress need not erase history.

LOW VOLTAGE, HIGH STAKES

Supporting the infrastructure behind data-driven environments.



Structured cabling, containment and controls no longer sit at the back of the queue.

Low voltage systems were, until relatively recently, often treated as secondary considerations within the broader delivery of building services. Typically introduced later in the design process and procured as client-direct or nominated packages, they were treated as supporting elements rather than core to overall building performance.

That position has changed. Clients are now engaging with these systems much earlier in the project lifecycle, with connectivity, controls, security and data now addressed as integral components of building delivery rather than standalone additions.

As these systems have moved earlier in the project lifecycle,

the nature of their delivery has also evolved. Within design and build environments, particularly across the commercial and hospitality sectors, low voltage systems are often procured directly by the client or through nominated vendors. However, responsibility for their coordination and integration typically sits with the main M&E contractor.

That time is over.



Digital guest experience, access control and energy management must run reliably around the clock.

There was a time when the technology package was the last conversation in a project. A scope handed to a specialist vendor after the real engineering had been settled. Structured cabling, access control, CCTV. Bolted on at the end, coordinated loosely, commissioned in a rush before handover.

Across every sector, technology systems are becoming central to how buildings operate. What was once considered ancillary infrastructure is now critical to security, communication, energy performance and operational efficiency. Extra

Low Voltage systems no longer sit at the back of the queue. They influence coordination strategy, programme sequencing and long-term building performance.

In commercial offices, clients expect seamless connectivity, advanced access control and integrated workplace systems. In hospitality and retail, digital guest experience platforms, surveillance and energy management must run reliably around the clock. Industrial and specialist facilities rely on monitoring, automation and real-time data to maintain operational continuity.

With this shift comes complexity.

Modern ELV scopes can include structured cabling, fibre backbones, security systems, access control, CCTV, BMS interfaces, energy monitoring, audio-visual systems and increasingly IoT-enabled devices. These systems are often procured through multiple vendors, some client-direct, others consultant-led. Interfaces between trades are no longer simple handovers. They require coordinated integration across mechanical, electrical and digital platforms.

From a delivery perspective, this creates risk if not managed early and deliberately. Programme sequencing is affected by technology installation and commissioning requirements. Ceiling closures may depend on access control cabling. Mechanical systems may rely on BMS integration before full testing can be completed. Security interfaces may require coordination between base build and fit-out scopes. When responsibilities are unclear, delays and cost variations follow.

ELV cannot be treated as a standalone package delivered at the tail end of a project. It must be coordinated from the outset, aligned with containment strategies, power distribution, plant interfaces and commissioning plans. Early design clarity, structured coordination and defined accountability reduce the likelihood of late-stage rework.

Mint has recognised that technology integration is becoming a differentiator in how projects are delivered. The conversation with clients increasingly extends beyond air-conditioning capacity and electrical loads to include digital resilience, data security and long-term system performance. The company has strengthened its internal capability accordingly:

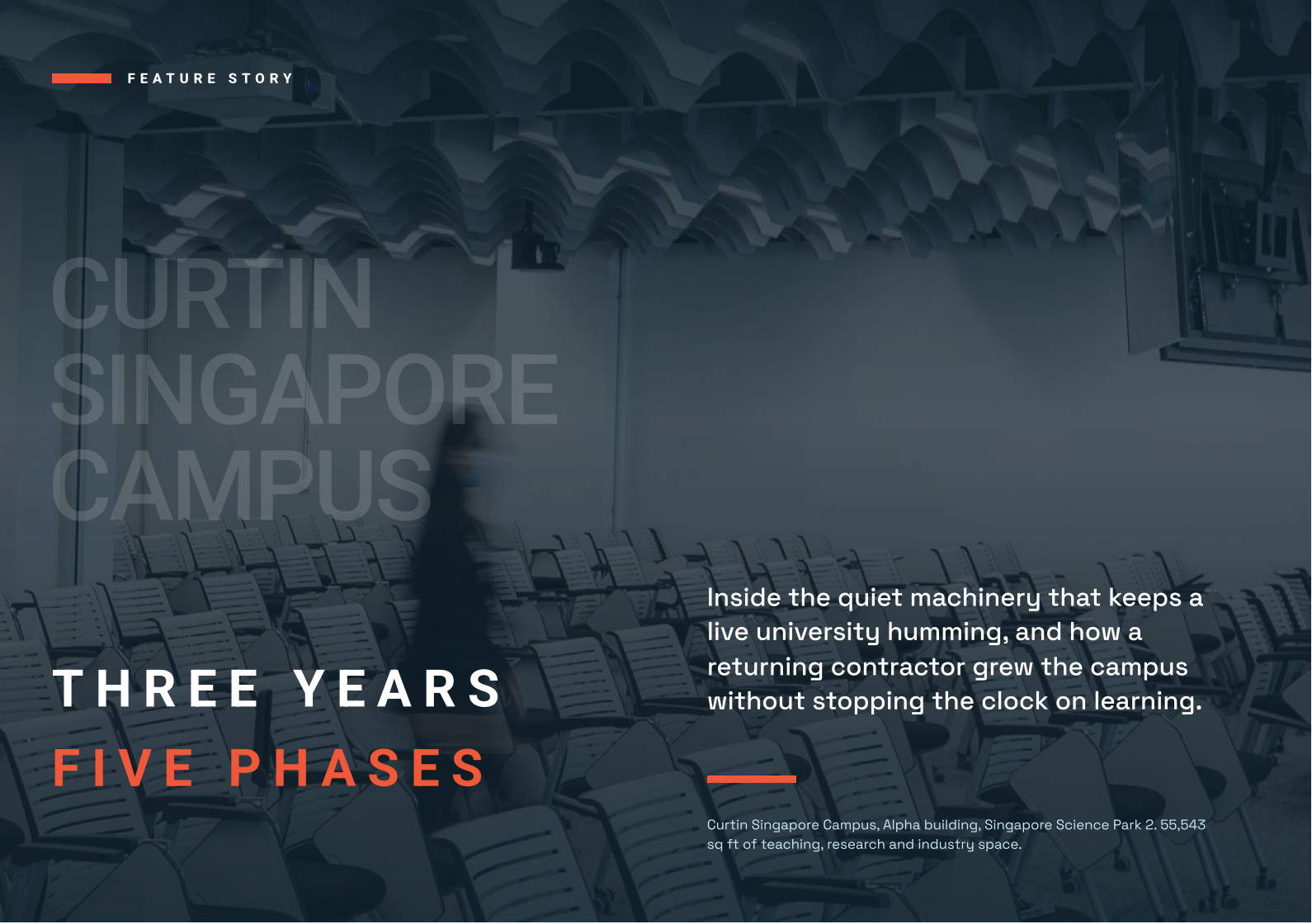
developing clearer coordination protocols between M&E and ELV systems, expanding specialist technical oversight and building regional knowledge across Singapore, Malaysia and Thailand.

The objective is not to duplicate specialist vendors, but to ensure that integration risk is actively managed within the overall delivery framework. Clearer definition of interfaces reduces ambiguity in procurement.

The trajectory is clear. Buildings are becoming more connected, more monitored, more dependent on data. As this continues, the distinction between traditional engineering and digital infrastructure will narrow. Technology is no longer an add-on. It is embedded within the fabric of modern building performance.

For clients, the expectation is straightforward: systems must work together from day one.

Mint's focus is to continue developing capability that reflects this reality: ensuring that as buildings become more intelligent, their delivery remains disciplined, coordinated and commercially controlled.



FEATURE STORY

CURTIN SINGAPORE CAMPUS

THREE YEARS
FIVE PHASES

Inside the quiet machinery that keeps a live university humming, and how a returning contractor grew the campus without stopping the clock on learning.

Curtin Singapore Campus, Alpha building, Singapore Science Park 2, 55,543 sq ft of teaching, research and industry space.

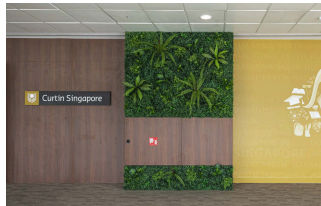


On weekday mornings at Singapore Science Park 2, the Alpha building fills with a tide of students. Card readers blink, screens wake, and a soft breath of cooled air follows people into classrooms.

It looks effortless. It isn't. Beneath the finishes and furniture sits the hidden architecture of a modern campus: power that never stutters, air that stays clean and comfortable in the tropics, water where it's needed, and protection that's felt more than seen.

When Curtin University chose to relocate its Singapore campus

into 55,543 square feet at Alpha, the brief was simple to say and hard to do: create a reliable, future-ready environment for teaching, research and industry engagement. Mint Building Services took the full M&E scope, electrical distribution, ACMV, plumbing and fire protection, and made it work in a live, tech-rich setting.



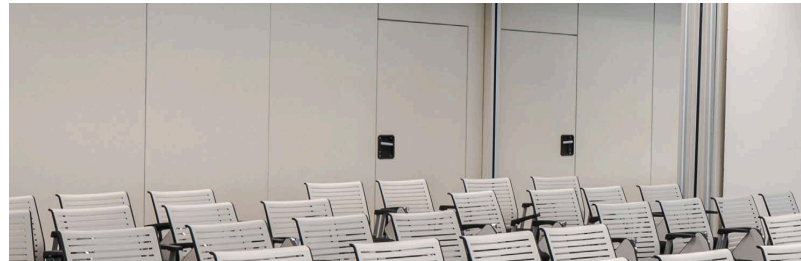
The move-in that set the tone

Phase 1 reached completion in May 2022. The fit-out brought 37 learning spaces online alongside three computer labs and two clinical skills labs, each with AV at its core.

Mint engineered electrical backbones to handle device-heavy teaching, balanced loads across the campus, and coordinated with AV to ensure clean power to sensitive kit.

On the environmental side, ACMV design focused on thermal comfort and indoor air quality, with zoning that matched real teaching patterns and duct routes that preserved ceiling heights. Fire systems and plumbing were laid out with maintenance in mind, because a campus is only as good as it is serviceable.

The result was a calm first day. Lights on. Screens up. No drama.



The science of settling in

Buildings teach you things when people arrive. Phase 2 was about listening.

Post-occupancy tuning refined airflows and temperature set-points, trimmed fan speeds to cut noise, and sharpened control sequences so

classrooms hit comfort faster after changeovers.

Power and data points were added where teaching teams found new rhythms; maintenance access was improved where experience showed tight spots. Small moves, measurable gains.

Teaching evolves; systems adapt

By the time Phase 3 rolled around, curriculum and class sizes had shifted and hybrid delivery was firmly part of the picture. Mint's task was to expand capacity without a rebuild. Electrical distribution was extended for higher device

density; data and AV provisions grew with it.

On the ACMV side, additional zones and smart controls helped target cooling to occupied spaces and squeeze more out of existing plant. The campus could flex, and the energy profile stayed sensible.



Works in a live campus

The real test of an engineering contractor isn't a clean empty site: it's a live building filled with people who need it to work every hour of the day.

Phase 4 demanded surgical sequencing. Night works kept noise down; sectional handovers split projects into bite-sized pieces; dust and odour controls protected teaching spaces.

At 9 a.m., classes started as if nothing had happened at 3 a.m.

Future-ready, not overbuilt

Phase 5, now in motion, looks ahead. The brief focuses on scalable infrastructure rather than shiny excess: electrical spines with room to grow; ventilation and chilled-water provisions ready for new suites; fire-life-safety coverage extended in step with space

planning; and practical efficiency measures to lower operational carbon.

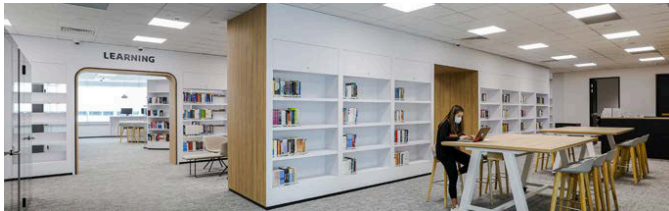
The point isn't to chase trophy metrics. It's to keep a university's core business, learning, steady while giving it headroom to evolve.

What good looks like (when no one's looking)

Walk the campus and the evidence is mostly invisible. Classrooms switch from lecture to seminar to recorded tutorial without tripping breakers.

Computer labs run quietly for hours. Clinical skills suites hold

temperature and airflow even when doors cycle. The BMS trend lines look boring in the best way. Maintenance teams can get to what they need to service without dismantling ceilings.



Our ongoing work at Curtin is really about reliability in a live environment. You protect the teaching day, make changes in smart increments, and keep improving the platform the university runs on.



Mark Donlon

Managing Director, Mint Building Services

Why the phasing mattered

Five phases over three years did more than spread cost; it reduced risk. Each tranche carried forward site knowledge, so fewer surprises turned up in ceilings and risers. Approvals came faster because

stakeholders already knew the playbook.

Lessons from the academic calendar, peaks, lulls and exam weeks, fed directly into the programme. The continuity saved time and, quietly, money.

A campus that fades into the background so the work can come to the front. For Mint, a clear statement of approach: deliver the right environment, then return to make it better.

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MINT BUILDING SERVICES

SINGAPORE

141 Cecil Street
Tung Ann Association Building, #04-05
Singapore 069541

MALAYSIA

150 Jalan Sultan Abdul Samad
Menara Sentral Vista, L12-6
50470 Brickfields, Kuala Lumpur

THAILAND

546 Ploenchit Rd
Canvas Ploenchit Building, 4F, Room 14
Lumphini, Pathumwan, Bangkok 10330